What is the Poem about?

In short, **“The Colour of God”** is a poem which seeks to disagree with anyone who thinks that God only belongs to their geographical location and race.

THE COLOUR OF GOD

BY: V.B AAKYE

Who ever painted God white

He must be black, says the black man

Of course not! He's got to be green,

quipped the green man

But that cannot be. He must

be red, assured the red one

How wrong you all are

He sure is blue, vows the blue one

How silly man is, laughs the rose

Why should he be black or white

Or green or yellow or even red?

Of course He is all these and more

Can't you see? He is

Even rose and emerald, yeah,

And damask and aquamarine

If you doubt me ask the rainbow!

Themes in the poem

1. Humankind needs to accept each other irrespective of racial or religious differences.

2. Humans cannot comprehend God in their own narrow mentality.

3. God is not limited to a single colour but represents different characteristics and personalities.

4. God does not belong to a particular geographical area or race.

Form and structure of the poem

The poem is a free verse with 16 lines. There is absence of rhymes or any stanzas. The language used is simple and easy to understand. The poem uses colours and inanimate objects to represent different people arguing about the personality and character of God.

Tone and Mood

* Argumentative

* Conversational

Literary devices in the poem

Personification

The literary device, personification is very dominant in the poem. Here are some examples.

1. He must be black, says the black man.

2. He must be red, assured the red one.

3. Laughs the rose

5. If you doubt me, ask the rainbow!

Rhetorical question

A rhetorical question is a question which is asked without expecting an answer. Here are some examples in the poem.

1. Why should he be black or white or green or yellow or even red?

2. He is all of these and more Can’ t you see?

Imagery

The poem appeals to our sense of sight by helping the reader to paint mental pictures. This is achieved by using colours and objects. Here are some examples in the poem.

1. And damask and aquamarine

2. If you doubt me ask the rainbow!

3. Whoever painted God white

5. Even rose and emerald, yeah,

Conclusion

The poem makes the reader aware of the need to accept our differences as a people regardless of race, geographical location, ethnic groups or religious backgrounds. It points out the fact that God has no colour and God is all colours. Therefore, there is no need for people to argue and create division. The poet challenges us to be open minded and avoid using religion and race to claim God. Thus avoid looking down on others for their background and beliefs about the character and personality of God.

Questions and Answers

1. “Laughs the rose” is an example of

ANS: Personification

2. Who thinks the colour of God is red?

ANS: The red one

3. God is colourless means

ANS: He does not belong to any group of people

4. Name any two literary devices found in the poem

ANS: Personification and Rhetorical question

5. Who vows God’s colour is blue?

ANS: The blue man

6. Name two themes in the poem

ANS: All Humans are equal

ANS: Racism and Division should not be encouraged

ANS: There should be peace and tolerance among people

7. State one moral lesson from the poem

ANS: People should not be judged based on their skin colour but character

8. How many lines are in the poem?

ANS: 16 lines

9. The poem ” the colour of God” was written by

ANS: V.B. Aakye

10. What is the nationality of the poet?

ANS: Ghanaian

11. What is the role of the “rose” in the colour of God?

ANS: The role of the rose is to show and guide the other colours to the truth about the character of God.

12. What image does the mention of rainbow create?

ANS: An image of unity among all people(colours)

13. What is the major theme of the poem colour of God? Support your answer with a line or two from the poem

ANS: Racial and religious discrimination should be avoided.

* Why should be be black or white

* of course He is all of these and more

14. What argument has the poet given to show that God is colourless?

ANS: In the line, “if you doubt me ask the rainbow, the poet encourages us to be open minded by taking a closer look at the multicoloured nature of the rainbow.

Since he does not identify with any particular colour, he is colourless.

15. Why is the content of a person’s character more important than the colour of his skin?

ANS: According to the passage, God sees all colour of people equally and hence, more importance should be given to our character.